

7 ANTI-SLOPSTYLE PROMPTS

Each prompt made the image in our post, first try. To use one, replace the subject sentence, the second sentence in each prompt, with your own. Keep everything else.

Bauhaus great for architecture, education, studios

1920s German school. Circles, squares and triangles in primary colours on paper. Nothing decorative, everything structural.

Bauhaus poster illustration, square format. A bicycle built only from flat geometric primitives: two large circles, one triangle frame, thin straight black lines. Palette limited to primary red, primary blue, primary yellow, black and warm off-white paper. Flat colour, no gradients, no shading, slight paper grain, generous empty space, strict grid alignment, one thin diagonal rule crossing the frame. No text, no letters, no numbers.

Constructivism great for gyms, fight clubs, streetwear

1920s Soviet poster art. Hard diagonals, red and black, one heroic silhouette. It shouts on purpose.

Russian Constructivist poster illustration, square format. A sprinter in black silhouette bursting along a steep diagonal from lower left to upper right. Palette strictly red, black and aged cream paper. Bold diagonal bars, a large flat red circle behind the figure, sharp wedge shapes, photomontage-style grain, rough ink texture. Flat shapes, high contrast, no gradients. No text, no letters, no numbers.

Pop art great for diners, food brands, retail

1960s comic panels. Halftone dots, thick black outlines and flat primary colour. Loud, cheap and cheerful.

1960s pop art comic panel illustration, square format. One giant red chilli pepper with a thick black outline and a glossy white highlight, centred, with a jagged yellow comic starburst behind it. Background filled with visible Ben-Day halftone dots in red on cream. Palette red, yellow, cyan blue, black and cream. Flat colours, offset-print misregistration, newsprint texture. No text, no letters, no speech bubbles, no numbers.

Mid-century great for coffee brands, cafes, podcasts

1950s cut-paper illustration. Muted teal, mustard and rust, simple shapes, a bit of texture. Warm without being cute.

1950s mid-century modern cut-paper illustration, square format. A record player on a small round table beside a leafy potted plant, a stylised sun through a window behind. Shapes look cut from coloured paper with slightly uneven edges. Palette muted teal, mustard yellow, burnt orange, cream and charcoal. Flat shapes, subtle paper grain and gouache texture, no outlines, no gradients, calm balanced composition. No text, no letters, no numbers.

7 ANTI-SLOPSTYLE PROMPTS, CONTINUED

Psychedelic great for festivals, drinks, vinyl

1960s festival posters. Melting curves, clashing warm colours, a sun that will not sit still.

1960s psychedelic festival poster illustration, square format. A huge sun with long wavy melting rays filling the frame, the rays rippling like heat haze into flowing liquid curves. Palette hot orange, magenta pink, deep purple and cream. Flat colour, thick undulating shapes, hand-drawn wobble, slight screen-print grain, symmetrical composition. No text, no letters, no numbers.

Retro futurism great for gaming, esports, arcades

The future as the 1980s imagined it. Pixel suns, neon grids, a black sky. Nostalgia with a power cable.

1980s retro-futurist arcade illustration in chunky pixel art, square format. A large pixelated setting sun in orange and yellow bands on the horizon, above a neon cyan perspective grid running to the vanishing point, a tiny pixel spaceship flying toward the sun, a starfield on a deep navy sky, a thin glowing magenta rounded frame around the scene. Crisp square pixels, limited palette, CRT scanline texture. No text, no letters, no numbers.

Memphis great for kids brands, stationery, pop-ups

1980s Milan. Squiggles, confetti, terrazzo and colours that should not work together. Playful and a little rude.

1980s Memphis Group pattern illustration, square format. A playful arrangement of bold squiggle lines, zigzags, half circles, cones, grids of black dots and terrazzo confetti shapes scattered with confident spacing. Palette pastel pink, mint, sunshine yellow, cobalt blue, black and white. Flat colour, thick black outlines on some shapes, hard drop shadows offset to one side, no gradients, clean vector look. No text, no letters, no numbers.

WHY THIS WORKS

Ask a model for something nice and you get the average of everything. Name a real movement, lock the palette, ban gradients and text, and it has a century of actual design to copy from. The same trick works for video and for websites.